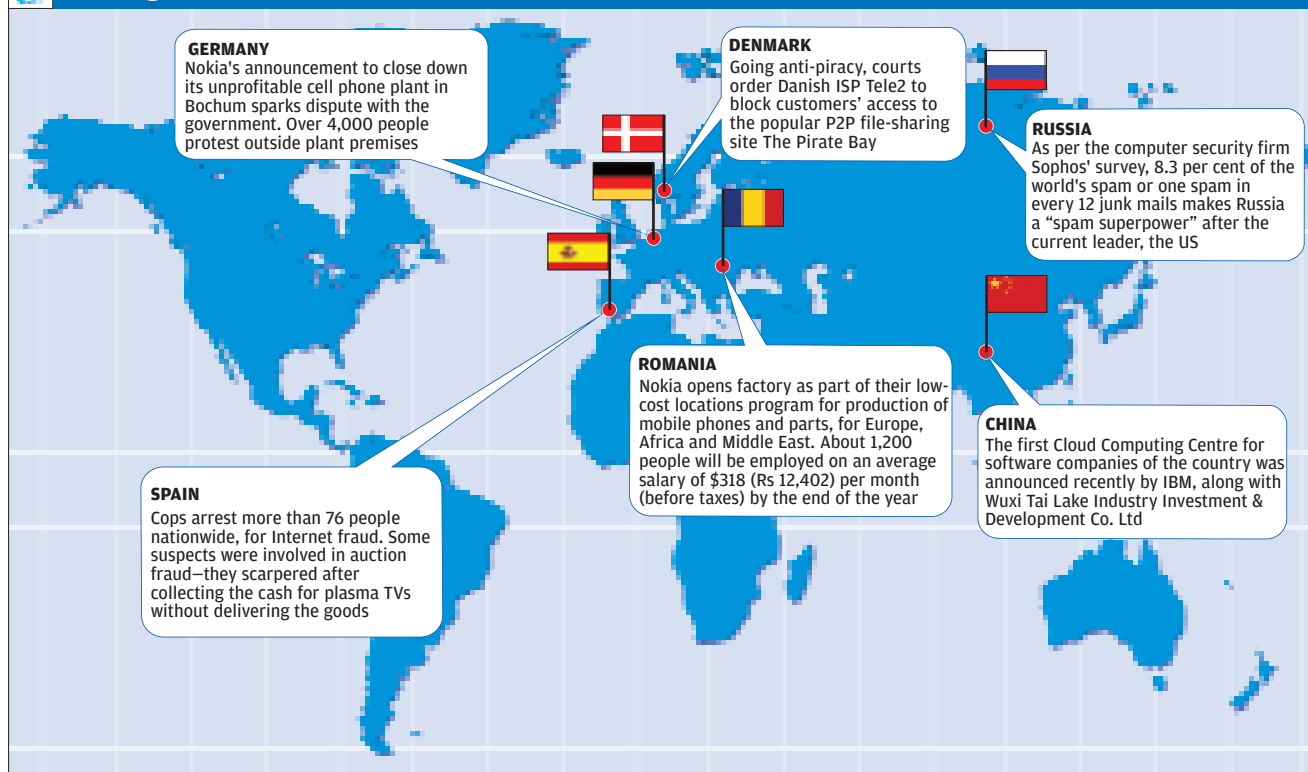


 The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe



also active in the media, this time around playing spoiler by claiming that Microsoft would use the deal to gain too much of control over the Internet.

We have also heard reports about AOL talking to Yahoo! for a likely deal. We believe that's not coincidence, considering the fact that Google owns a 5 per cent stake in AOL. Rupert Murdoch's News Corp. also joined in the league, by recently holding talks with Yahoo!

The Chinese portal Alibaba, however, is an important factor in the whole deal. For those of you'll who haven't heard of it, Alibaba is a Hangzhou-based e-commerce / e-auction company, and a significant player in China's search engine and online marketing industry after Baidu. Yahoo! is a major stakeholder in Alibaba. Softbank, a Japanese telecommunications company, which bought out Vodafone Japan, also owns a 3.9 per cent stake in Yahoo US and 40 per cent of Yahoo Japan. In addition to this,

both Softbank and Yahoo, are common investors in Alibaba. Being a dominant player in China, this deal is being closely watched by Chinese authorities—concerned over foreign control of Chinese businesses, especially with Microsoft, considering its monopolistic policies and practices.

The deal between the two companies has not yet been signed, and it already has effects on China and Japan. But what are the possible impacts in India? As far as Indian surfers are concerned, Google ranks the highest, followed by Yahoo! at a distant second place, and then MSN. Unlike other countries where the competition is stiff, in India, Google really holds a significant lead over the other search engines. Could this translate into a reduction in PPC rates for online advertising? SEO professionals would surely be watching this closely. So, for India, things don't seem to be as significant anyway. Surely services are

only going to improve with the competition. They've got to!

YOU'RE HIT!

The Great Indian Virus

India and technology seem to be in the news quite often these days. A few weeks back, it was low browsing speeds due to the cut in the Middle Eastern optical fibre (FALCON) belonging to FLAG Telecom, under the flagship of the Reliance ADA group. To add to these woes, a recent study on virus activity by a web security services company indicates that India has the highest incidence of virus attacks.

As per the study conducted by MessageLabs, "Virus activity increased across a number of countries in January, including India, which takes the number one spot with 1 in 30.5 emails". As compared to India, the Web attack was far less in

western countries with figures being one in every 191.5 emails in the US and one in every 158.4 e-mails in Canada. In New Zealand, Web security levels were pretty good—one out of 768 mails was virus infested, while for Australia, the figure was one for every 298.7 mails. The study goes on to reveal that the global spam ratio is 73 per cent. This translates to one in every 1.36 emails. This only further reiterates the need for us to be updated with the latest anti-virus, anti-spam, anti-spyware and other proactive tools to ensure safety. In taking such measures, not only are we safer as individuals, but rather reduce the risk to others, especially our friends and close associates.

SOMETHING INSIDE

Micro-buzz

After the series of anti-trust battles between Microsoft and the EU, it now seems